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Applying a communication innovation to another country

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Abstrakt

Tato práce analyzuje značku a komunikaci ruské společnosti Aviasales, která se zaměřuje na mladé lidi (generace Z). Cílem práce je analyzovat prvky komunikace, které lze úspěšně přenést do jiného tržního kontextu a využít je ke zlepšení marketingové komunikace konkrétní společnosti - Student Agency.

Nejprve je zvažována generace, na kterou jsou tyto komunikační prvky zaměřeny. Dále jsou popsány marketingové a komunikační strategie, jejich součásti a trendy v moderní komunikaci, včetně autenticity značky. Poté následuje popis jednotlivých kroků při tvorbě komunikační strategie. V praktické části je na základě těchto údajů provedena studie ruské společnosti. Dále je vybrána česká společnost a jsou identifikovány prvky, které lze využít.

Výsledkem práce je návrh, nikoliv konečný výsledek - přesto jej lze využít k vytvoření dlouhodobé komunikace značky.

Klíčová slova

Komunikace, inovace, Aviasales, segment cestování, Student Agency, odvětví pohostinství

JEL klasifikace

M31 Marketing

Abstract

This paper analyses the brand and communication of the Russian company Aviasales, targeting young people (Generation Z). The aim of the paper is to analyse elements of communication that can be successfully transferred to another market context and used to improve the marketing communication of a particular company - Student Agency.

First of all, the generations targeted by such communication elements are considered. Next, the marketing and communication strategies, their components, and trends in modern communication, including brand authenticity, are described. This is followed by a description of the steps involved in creating a communication strategy. In the practical part, a study of a Russian company is conducted on the basis of these data. Next, the Czech company is selected and the elements that can be used are identified.

The result of the work is a proposal, not an end result - nevertheless, it can be used to create long-term brand communication.

Keywords

communication, innovation, Aviasales, travel segment, Student Agency, hospitality industry

JEL Classification

M31 Marketing

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Introduction

Problem and context definition

We live in a time of consumerism and acceleration, which makes us less receptive to advertisements. This circumstance creates a challenge for marketers, it tests the ability to orient in a rapidly changing environment and various tools of influence. In this context, the ability to create not only first-class but also unique advertisement strategies is becoming an evident competitive advantage. It has been proven by the Russian flight ticket metasearch engine Aviasales. High performance is present due not only to the excellent service of the company but also to outstanding solutions in the field of travel marketing. The atypical nature of the brand is obvious in comparison with competitors: travel brands usually do not go beyond the obvious needs of the market segment, do not try to win customer loyalty or become something more than just a search engine. The key element of the innovation is an authentic brand positioning, which is incarnated in being consistent in communication and style, being loyal to its principles, being honest with customers and itself, and putting customers first. Due to the company's positive and bold tone of voice and attention to people mentioning it in the social media environment, there's a feeling of a nice and easy-going personality behind the brand which is considered rather a friend, not a real seller. Aviasales marketers approach the process with humour and dynamics, following the news and latest trends to use it for good. So it is more about the general style of marketing that makes the company so unique and famous. The creative ideas that the company implements are inspiring. Compared to the creative solutions of this company, the self-propagation of Czech companies in the same area seems full of potential, so in this paper, I would like to bring a certain communication style to the Czech market.

A precise definition of the goal

The ultimate goal of the paper is to create an effective communication style inspired by Aviasales example, yet suitable for the Czech market and one of the companies in a similar field. The key metric of the project's success is positive feedback from three professionals in the field of marketing and communication, but there is also an intention of implementation of the strategy in the future (might be post-COVID19 future, since it's especially tough times for such a field to try new strategies). The result of the work should be a ready-made set of strategic suggestions that can be recommended to a suitable Czech company.

Methodology

The basic method of gathering input information about marketing solutions of the said Russian company is to search for Internet sources and conduct research in the form of a survey to get the idea of how Russian customers perceive the company's communication and what aspects of it they assume are the most influential. The results will be used as a basis for the draft of a communication strategy.

After creating a communication strategy using the SOSTAC method, testing is performed with a sample of at least three experts in the field of marketing in the form of providing expert opinion, which reveals whether the strategy has potential and is applicable. The findings from the research will be summarised in the conclusion of this thesis.

Work's structure

The work will consist of two parts, theoretical and practical.

In the theoretical part, the overview of the generations and the expertise concerning the creation of a communication strategy will be summed up. First, the crucial concept of marketing communication (marketing communication itself and the planning that includes the research (markets, product and target audience), goals of the communication, strategy, (action and control) and the latest trends. Last but not least, it is necessary to identify and describe modern (and expected) trends in marketing concerning the acceleration of technological progress that might influence the particular case. The next chapter will be devoted to selected steps for planning and designing a relevant communication strategy.

In the practical part, with the help of research of the Internet sources, I will analyse the perception of above-mentioned creative communication, Aviasales and similar companies on the Czech market, their economic indicators, target audiences and suitable promotion tools, compare their communication strategies and choose a company that will be most suitable for adaptation marketing innovative strategy. The part will then consist of the creation of the right style (defining the SOSTAC technique and its following components and then applying them), testing (in a form of feedback from three professionals) and the following analysis and evaluation of the testing results.

Theoretical part

1 The concept of generations

1.1 Introduction

This paper is based on the assumption that different groups of people need different approaches to advertising, and that advertising needs constant development in order to meet people's needs. In order to better understand the specifics of marketing aimed at today's young people, it will be useful for us to understand the differences between different generations and the specifics of their thinking and needs. We will focus mainly on the generation Z.

1.2 Definition of generation, the generations types

The idea of generations, proposed by Mannheim in 1923, is firmly embedded in our lives in the fields of sociology, cultural studies, political science and economics. A generation in the sense of a sociological phenomenon is the approximate division of society into groups based on age characteristics. Generally, people of the same age are shaped by particular events or circumstances peculiar to a particular historical time (Pilcher, 1994). These groups, which pass through age strata simultaneously, share similar experiences that form unique characteristics that are common to the whole group (Kertzer, 1983). According to Pilcher (1994), the consciousness and mental component of the individual is shaped by socio-cultural factors, and thus the way of thinking, mental structure and knowledge itself differs across generations. It should be noted that generations have common features throughout the world, but they all differ depending on the particular country, nation, and cultural tradition to which they belong (Scholz & Rennig, 2019).

For the purposes of this paper, we will look at five generations: The silent generation, Baby boomers, Generation X, Generation Y and Generation Z.

The silent generation consists of those born before 1949. The main impact on their lives was a global upheaval: the Second World War. Because of this circumstance, the life of the generation was based on the idea of survival and regeneration: this gave rise to the hippy culture, the idea of the high value of human life and figures such as John Lennon, Bob Dylan and Leonard Cohen - Influencers whose work was permeated with the idea of non-military solutions. A generation's life was defined by hard work, they could afford to own a car or go on holiday. To this day, individual members of the generation have influenced political and economic institutions, but this is rather a rare exception due to natural causes.

The baby boomers generation - born between 1950 and 1964 - were defined by events like space exploration, the Vietnam War and a technological leap, with TV becoming part of everyday life for the average family. This generation fought for the democratisation of

institutions and academia while also trying to improve not only their lives but the world as a whole.

Generation X, born between 1965 and 1979, is seen as a generation whose lives became more complicated than the previous ones. This contributed to the development of a negative outlook on life. Nevertheless, this generation has received a noticeably better education, which has also contributed to the development of the labour market.

Generation Y, more commonly referred to as Millennials, is limited to people born between 1980 and 1994. They have been most influenced by the development of technology and the advent of the internet. As such, they are strikingly different from previous generations. The generation is characterised by optimism when it comes to personal development prospects.

Generation Z, beginning in 1995, is characterised by realism compared to Millennials. They understand that the promises of politicians and marketing experts do not match reality, and no curriculum will prepare them for the complexities of real life (Scholz & Rennig, 2019).

1.3 Generation Z and marketing communication

Generation Z is dependant on structure and security, which makes it essential to “feel good”. These tendencies are spread in every part of life: home, work, social and academic environment. Due to the realistic and critical approach to life, they are less loyal to brands and employers - the individuality and personal value are more important and the level of formal commitments is significantly lower than in the previous generations. Gen Z is more practical and pragmatic, more globally-oriented and less focused on work successes. It has a firm connection to modern information technologies, which are influencing young people all over the world: it means that, in comparison with the previous generations, Gen Z is the first global generation, its values, principles and aspirations are similar wherever the internet access is stable.

Gen Z is considered more independent and efficient than Gen Y, from which “the major change was expected”, so it is called by researchers “The generation of hope”. It means, that there is a real potential in the growing-up generation to change the world for the better. The generation is also turning out to be the cleverest of all because it is the first one to grow and develop in a fully informational society. It doesn't mean they are the most intelligent or the smartest one, it is more about the number of sources available and the ability to use them. That is mostly about electronic media because the press and classical media are associated with hidden propaganda. That, on the other hand, creates the dependency on the internet and digital sources of information.

For businesses, it is important to understand the concept of authenticity and win trust. Generation Z is less loyal, yet, it is caused by their ability to see through implicit intentions. It might be essential to not only expect loyalty from this generation but also give it back, so it is not one-sided. It works for both employing Gen Z and selling to them (Scholz & Rennig, 2019).

The most important brand there is for a Gen Z representative is themselves: they are preoccupied with building their own selves and do not want to be a walking advertisement for someone else, they want to be their own heroes. That means that a brand should support this vision and reflect their values (Fromm & Read, 2018).

It is not enough to be perfect for the company - now it is needed to be unique. Being honest and authentic is essential and for that, mistakes are forgiven. Moreover, mistakes are considered essential for growth and because of that, Gen Z welcomes the acceptance of mistakes by influencers, businesses and products. Raised by Gen X, Gen Z is focused on such values as “sincerity”, “trust” and “ethics”. Yet, independence and creativity are valued higher than respect. For brands, it is necessary to not deliver storytelling, but real actions in order to win their trust (Van & Behrer, 2016).

1.4 Summary

We have deconstructed the generations and their characteristics: it is clear that cultural and social circumstances influence the formation of people and groups. The latest generations, Millennials and Generation Z, emerged and evolved in an environment of advanced technology and the internet, so they are radically different from previous generations. In marketing aimed at Generation Z, sincerity, authenticity, independence and trust are important.

2 Marketing communication and communication strategy

2.1 Introduction

This work deals with marketing communication and communication strategy and therefore it is necessary to dive into the study of these concepts. We will analyse and dive into such topics, as marketing communication, its purpose and meaning, integrated marketing communication, tools and current trends in the field.

2.2 Marketing communication

According to Peter Drucker, “any business enterprise has two – and only these two – basic functions: marketing and innovation” (Drucker, 2007). In this work, I will primarily concentrate on the first aspect. The idea of "marketing" appeared in economics literature in the late 19th century and developed as "merchandising and sales" under the scientific direction of Frederick Winslow Taylor; since then, marketing has been a tool for organizing the regulation of supply and demand, supporting a mutually beneficial exchange of values between the seller and the buyer (Varey, 2002). In other words, marketing is concerned with providing the conditions of communication and information that allow meeting the demand for satisfaction of needs through the production of goods and services.

One of the principles of effective marketing is that actions are aimed at meeting the needs of the consumer. Thus, a set of integrated marketing tools can bring tangible positive results for the entire company. Communication between the parties is optional, but decades of marketing experience proves that marketing communication must be planned and managed to achieve these results - in this way it benefits everyone (Varey, 2002). Thus, the use of effective communication methods is essential for the development and prosperity of a company, especially in times of intense modern competition.

Sounding easy in theory, achieving this goal is facilitated by the use of appropriate and well-thought-through communication created by the company. Communication itself can be defined as the transfer of information aimed at creating mutual understanding and generating a response; to complete this task, special plans of meeting the external and internal communication needs of an organization or a media personality are made, they are generally called communication strategies (Carney, Lymer, 2015). It should be noted that due to the novelty of a deep study of the field, there are various definitions of communication, and with the help of Occam's razor, I have chosen the most capacious one.

Considering all of the above, it is also necessary to understand that communication is not identical to the concept of promotion and an intrusive product offering. It often happens that communication goes beyond planned actions. Everything that somehow gives an idea of the company is communication, even if it was not planned. It's necessary to remember that marketing is, first of all, a social process, and everyone who interacts with the product on any level is involved in it.

That is the reason why Grönroos (2000) uses the term market communication instead. It shows that both sides of purchase, vendor and purchaser, have to communicate effectively to meet the objective, so it becomes a managerial responsibility to ensure the trustworthy and mutually beneficial deal flow on every level: 'everything communicates something about a firm and its good and services – regardless of whether the marketer accepts this and acts upon it or not' (Grönroos, 2000).

2.3 The purpose of marketing communication

Nowadays marketing communication is seen as a strategic matter, which involves efforts to expand value obtained by the customer. This process has two main objectives: to create preference and to shorten the sales cycle. Creating preference is a long-term process that makes it possible to position a product or a company in the minds of the target audience developing and using a set of communication tools. Successful positioning of this kind leads to market share increase, expected rise in profitability levels and betterment of talent management due to improved attractiveness and promising outlook of a company among potential applicants. All of this creates an essential long-term value for a company which leads to the possibility of further development. Shortening the sales cycle is also an essential tool for a company's development, it consists of helping sales and partners to identify, engage and leave customers satisfied. Compared to the creating preference objective, which has a brand-building character, it is rather a tactical set of tasks that brings incremental improvements in a short-term perspective. Nevertheless, in the long term, it brings significant value. Shortening the sales cycle decreases costs on sales and marketing and increases the number of customers and profit. To achieve that, it is necessary to examine and understand the whole customer experience. For example, sometimes a great amount of customer education is needed in the early stages of the process, and it is on marketing communication to create and deliver the information to the buyer to have a sale. It is necessary to balance these two objectives to make the most out of marketing communication (Wiefels, 2002)

The overall result of these efforts should be the position of the company as an effective and preferred source of solutions to the problems faced by people as clients and consumers. This is the goal of management in planning, creating and managing marketing communications. The challenge is to make expressive communication clear, comprehensive and consistent and to foster effective communication that helps to make judgments and decisions. Marketing communication is expanding to embrace the idea that a healthy customer-supplier relationship is the foundation of any successful business. There is also an increasing request for stakeholder relationships based on trust and commitment (Varey, 2000).

Taking into consideration everything aforesaid, defining marketing communication is still tricky because it includes all the possible messages and activities a company uses to persuade consumers to perceive and accept its messages and act accordingly. This is too broad and complicated to work within any practical realm, that is why we use a different term for addressing the process of coordinating all these different activities throughout various communication methods - integrated marketing communication.

2.4 Integrated marketing communication

Integrated marketing communication is the transition to a technology-based, more personalised and customer-based marketing system of communication. It is managed by a marketing team at the brand level that integrates marketing and various marketing communications. Brand management requires the integration of communication systems, especially when it is required that regular customers are treated differently from potential customers.

The reason for the heightened interest in discussing complex marketing communications in research and practice is the enormous potential that integrated marketing communication has to influence business performance, provide a competitive advantage to companies, increase brand equity, and provide effective and consistent communications to drive the public relations and marketing objectives. (Luxton, 2-15; Madhavaram, 2005; Reid, 2003).

As the number of media communications is growing, the difficulty and cost of reaching the target audiences are also getting higher. Therefore, the concept of integrated marketing communications is increasingly used nowadays. The purpose of this system is to establish consistency to improve the efficiency of all communication activities (Belch & Belch, 2006; Schultz, 1996; Bruhn, 2006).

2.5 Tools of marketing communication

Nowadays it is especially important to pay attention to building a suitable way of communication with the public since technological development keeps accelerating and creating the space for overwhelming mass communication that quickly becomes “white noise” due to a person’s inability to pay attention to every single piece of it. Thus marketers face the new objective of establishing and maintaining beneficial interaction with target customers, both current and potential, and achieving this objective requires the knowledgeable ability to make wise choices in regards to ways of communication. The ways are generally recognised as “communication tools”, they include methods, techniques and actions which help the information about the brand and its products and services reach target customers. They are used within the fourth part of the complex foundational “marketing mix” model centred around four “P” - product, price, place, and promotion.

The term “marketing mix” was introduced in 1948 by Neil Borden, a professor of business and advertisement in Harvard Business School, and since then has been widely used to “mix the ingredients” of successful promotion. All four elements of the mix are deeply

interconnected and failure of one will lead to the failure of others. That is why the marketing mix includes all the marketing decisions needed to secure and guarantee the process.

Till today it is considered an essential element in the decision-making process that leads to the practical implementation of a marketing strategy or execution of a particular plan. With time, the other “P” models developed (e.g. Seven “P”), but the four “P” model stays the most relevant because it is universal and might be adjusted accordingly for the particular service.

The area of marketing communication is concerned primarily with promotion - the last “P” of the marketing mix, but also collaterally it is responsible for strong sales, customer demand and both image of a company and well-minded attitudes towards it or its activities and accomplishments. Therefore, it also influences business connections and investment relations. Considering all said above, it is indisputable that choosing the right communication tools is fundamental for a company’s wellbeing and prosperity in the realms of modern markets.

Marketing communication mix is a distinct set of tools to build up value for customers and create customer relationships. According to McCarthy (1998), the marketing communication mix is defined as a specific consolidation of components that are used to achieve the marketing targets: advertising, personal selling, sales promotion, public relations and direct marketing. The communication endeavours must be prepared and conducted perfectly in the right order, to be comprehensive and integrated, since all marketing communication elements are different but closely interrelated.

Efficient promotion is based on the right consolidation of the abovementioned components, so it is important to evaluate the profitability of one or another element and find the best way to put them together. All the tools play peculiar roles in the process and it is necessary to have a fine taste in them.

2.5.1 Advertisement

Advertising is considered to be a presentation of ideas or product on TV, the print media, network communications, electronic and display media (Kotler and Keller, 2012). Advertisement has several objectives. The first of them is to inform the target customer, then follows the functions of persuasion and reminding. Due to that, goods, services and brands are expected to look more appealing than those competitor ones. Advertisement adds value to the products, aiming to persuade a customer to make the next desirable step, whether to know more about the product or buy it.

Advertisement is considered to be more effective than personal sales because it is less costly and less time-demanding, there is also more control for advertisers in this form because it allows them to define the layout, the time frame and the future outlook for the advertised piece. Moreover, it elevates the levels of customer brand awareness which leads to the transaction being held in a more modern fashion (e.g. self-service type of purchases). Advertising exists in many types and forms, in every area of public life, and it is difficult to imagine a company that would manage without it nowadays. The efficiency and advance of the advertisement are dependent on funds, so budgeting is especially important for creating

a successful advertisement plan. Advertisement budgets are determined by the type of a company and its size, its developmental strategy and the current market situation. Bigger enterprises can afford to participate in a larger number of advertising activities, and that creates a spiral-like movement, letting companies grow.

2.5.2 Personal selling

Talking about personal selling, we talk about some form of personal presentation of a product, service or concept to a buyer. As stated above, personal selling is less effective than a complex advertisement, especially in times of mass propagation trends. Occasions, when personal sales are used as an only means of promotion, are rare and almost do not appear within the realm of B2C communication these days. It is used rather as a measure that supports the set of stronger promotional tactics.

2.5.3 Sales promotion

Sales promotion is used to influence a customer to purchase a product. Here, we talk primarily about short-term stimulation aiming to accelerate the decision-making process, and that is being achieved by reckoning up the value of a product in a limited set of time to create an idea of confine and restriction - the offer will not be there in a short time, so “it is better to hurry up”. It is also widely associated with such things as coupons, samples and discounts since they make an impression of adding extra value to the existing product. Sales inducing might be targeted in the frames of both B2C and B2B communications. Advertisement creates awareness of the product’s values and makes a purchase seem reasonable, while sales promotion accelerates selling itself, giving a good reason to buy it “here and now”. This approach is exceptionally helpful when a situation requires a rapid change of buyer’s behaviour, it provides a short-term benefit in terms of sales increase. However, it is difficult to create a lasting quality customer relationship using this method. Nevertheless, it might be also used with a company's staff to stimulate labour and effective performance.

2.5.4 Public relations

Public relations, widely known as “PR”, create a significant part of marketing within a company. Public relations are especially important because they do not focus on a particular product or service of a company, but a company itself as a whole. They are involved in every activity and incorporate all the company’s communication - it is a huge interactive structure, which considers its main goal to affect public opinion about a company and sometimes an area it belongs to. Public relations aim to build understanding and cooperation with the public - the customers - and create the environment within a company that would make managers prioritise customers and serve public interests. Using trends estimation and research, they help to ensure that management is aware of the current circumstances and always act within the frame of ethical communication. We can surely state that these days anything that is connected in any way to the marketing activities of a company is considered to be public relations. All the printed materials issued for public usage, participation in sponsoring or fundraising, engagement in public activities such as fairs and conferences.

Public relations are responsible for creating convenient conditions for cooperation and interaction between the company and the customers.

2.5.5 Direct marketing

Direct marketing is the last, but not least component, since it is considered to be one of the rapidly growing sectors of the world markets. In the case of direct marketing, we are talking about the direct communication between the company and its direct customers that aim for getting a reaction from customers or inspire them to make a transaction. Direct marketing was not regarded as a part of the marketing mix till recent times, since it has gained significant value for the promotional process and specifically integrated marketing communication. While it is often considered to be about having an internet store or sending emails to customers, direct marketing represents a complex system that generally has multiple strategies with different target groups, funds and objectives. This type of communication is deeply personal in comparison with the types mentioned above, and it is measurable. Due to the fast development of the internet and the technological constituent of business processes, direct marketing is also developing fast and opens new ways for promotion, marketing and sales growth. Direct marketing includes such well-known forms of online communication as email marketing, seminars, advertising product catalogues and web marketing. The tools of direct marketing might immensely help with achieving the goals of boosting online selling or making customers return after purchase. The ideal direct marketing strategy aims to reach the appropriate segmented audience at the appropriate stage of the customer journey with the appropriate idea or message. This way, thanks to modern technologies and the internet, organisations have the opportunity to create direct communications with the customers which allow them to present, offer and sell products and services using web pages, applications, social networks and means of e-commerce such as e-shops. Being able to construct the environment of a company's online presence is essential for modern businesses because it is stable, reasonably priced and quick. It often eliminates intermediate steps between the company and the customers, so using direct marketing becomes remarkably cost-effective. One of the downsides of modern direct marketing is that it easily might become intrusive and not respectful towards customers' privacy, but as long as public moralities and legal regulations are respected, direct marketing is a perfect tool to use, considering its cost/benefit ratio. While used properly, it supports and reinforces the company's growth by creating a strong and persuasive marketing communication mix.

2.6 The current trends in marketing communication

Intensive development of production capacity and marketing discipline in the second half of the twentieth century led to the fact that the relationship with the customer was replaced by the attitude to the consumer group, which contributed to the emergence of a culture of consumerism, leading to an ever-increasing volume of goods and products consumed. However, recently, under the influence of the development of information technologies and new forms of mass communication, as well as the dissemination of information about the harm caused by mass production to the environment, more and more buyers are rethinking

the concept of obtaining things and services. It is often believed that the consumer is becoming more and more demanding and selective. This, along with modern market conditions, leads to a renewal of communication between the parties to the exchange process: it returns to the format of personal relationships (Varey, 2002). Due to the rapid development of technology, traditional marketing theory is often indispensable and requires constant innovation, corresponding to the ubiquitous acceleration of processes and communication opportunities (Varey, 2002).

The advent of the Internet has brought about significant changes in the field of interpersonal communication. In its early days, the Internet was perceived and viewed as a publishing platform that helped companies disseminate information to a wide variety of audiences, in fact, the general public. At the time, consumers could only search for information and analyze it, so adding content was reserved for businesses and interaction was limited. (Kaplan and Haenlein, 2010).

The rise of social media has influenced the emergence of a new and unique dimension of communication, making it multi-faceted, rather than coming exclusively from the company.

As a consequence of this change, the focus of communication is shifting "from companies to consumers, from individuals to communities, nodes to networks, publishing to participation and invasion to an invitation." (Berthon, Pitt, Plangger, and Shapiro 2012).

Companies can use social media to interact with their customers (a single communication between a company and a customer), and at the same time, customers can use social media to interact with a company (communication between a customer and a company) and with other customers (communication with a customer). (Buyers; Mangold and Faulds, 2009).

Thus, we can say that social media offers both companies and customers new and effective ways to interact with each other so that this kind of communication becomes easier and more effective. (Wang, Yu, Wei., 2012). The advent of electronic media and technology, on one hand, makes it easier to communicate with their customers and on other hand, places new requirements on used instruments.

2.7 Summary

In this chapter we have described the importance and purpose of marketing communication. We have looked through specific tools of marketing communication and the latest trends of the field. It is becoming evident that brand authenticity is valued more and more in past years and emotional connection is needed to be built with the customer in order to achieve a mutually satisfying experience.

3 Communication strategy

3.1 Introduction

Having elaborated on the nature of marketing communication and its importance both historically and nowadays, we can now expand the comprehension of specific ways of using it in practice to make the communication between a company and a customer effective and reciprocally beneficial. For this, companies use the above mentioned integrated marketing communication which consists of particular procedures united by the same period, budget, target audience and goals - marketing communication strategies. According to Baker (2014), marketing strategy planning in its broader sense consists of six stages: to identify the need that the company is capable of satisfying, to find the best match within the target audience (a specific part of a large segment that matches company's capabilities and brand identity the most), to design and produce the needed product or service, prepare a marketing communication plan to gain the attention of a specific kind, execute the plan and monitor and analyse the result to evaluate the work done and get insights for future development. Thus, marketing strategy is a term that is broader than just product promotion and in this work, I will refer to promotion strategy as a marketing communication strategy.

3.2 The purpose of communication strategy

The purpose of marketing, according to Baker (2014), is to establish and preserve the reciprocally rewarding transactional relationship between a company and its customers, meaning that "rewarding" from the customer's side is empowering to repeat the experience if the same need is present again. In times of mature and sophisticated markets, it means that closer contact between the company and the audience is needed and to establish it, marketers plan, create and execute marketing strategies. The main purpose of strategies is to create and maintain a brand's competitive advantage. We can say that the communication strategy of the organization is one of the marketing management tools that promote the maintenance of relationships and mutual exchange between the two parties involved.

3.3 Communication strategy planning

Planning is needed to get an understandable idea of the company's place on the market and the product category. It aims to find and use the advantages of the current situation and uncover and eliminate possible risks (Blakeman, 2018).

Communication strategy planning consists of two principally different phases, they are the strategic planning phase and the tactical planning phase. To achieve the best results, we have to start the process with careful strategic preparation, which includes, first of all, the

stage of research of market, product and customer. After identifying the market situation, characteristics of the product and the target audience analysis, it is needed to set clear and objective goals connected to user profile and market expansion. After that comes defining the level of appropriation (the rough budget estimation), formulating the strategy and integrating it into the overall marketing strategy of the company. In the tactical planning phase, there are such stages as developing a budget, examining possible legal complications, making a media plan and reviewing the whole strategy by the parties uninvolved in creation. After all of that is done, a strategy might be implemented. After it is finished, we can review and revisit the whole project, control goals fulfilment and identify key learning points (Paley, 2007). The chosen method can be abbreviated into a simple name: SOSTAC (situation analysis, objectives, strategy, tactics, actions, control).

3.3.1 Research: market, product, customer

The pre-campaign research is often called “situation analysis - SWOT”. It is essential to conduct a careful situational analysis before developing any kind of communication strategy or advertisement campaign. The analysis is done in three steps: market, product and customer research. The first, market analysis, is in its essence the research of a competitive environment. It's important to research the field of competitive products or services, companies and the up-to-date industry trends, competitive brands positioning, their unique selling propositions, choice of propagation tools, their audience characteristics and reasoning behind their behaviour. The following product research is focused exclusively on the product offered by the company. The aim is to gather objective information on the product perception by its current or potential users to make the right choices in terms of product positioning and propagation. In the third stage, customer analysis, the research is focused on creating and understanding psychological, behavioural and sometimes demographic profiles of current and prospective product users. It is useful to know how often they make purchases, how old they are, what their education is, what income levels they have, what groups they belong to and what moves them in life. These factors tend to differ depending on the company and its' product, but knowing how the customer thinks and acts is essential for any marketing activities. In the era of advanced advertisement in mature markets, it is also needed to understand the interests, habits and values of the audience to be able to win over competitors. Gathering all the input together, we can create a comprehensible SWOT matrix model - it includes Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats of the current situation - which helps to proceed to the next phase (setting the objectives).

There are two types of data being available for the research: qualitative and quantitative. Qualitative data can be gathered through focused groups activities, interviews and polling. In this case, we are collecting opinions and perspectives which are open-ended by nature and serve for the creation of aggregated comprehension of subjective points of view. Talking about quantitative data, we mean close-ended, controlled research, usually taking the form of surveys, that help to create a clear numbers-related, statistical understanding of the subject researched (Blakeman, 2018).

3.3.2 Setting strategy objectives

Goals are defined based on the current situation and place of the company, but they always include the final change that should happen as a result of the marketing activities. At this point, market and user target profiles are being formulated. It's important to specify from the beginning what profit or other outcomes should be achieved (sales, brand awareness, etc.). Based on the previous research, it is needed to formulate what, how and for whom is being delivered.

Goals are dependent on the problems that a target customer or a product/service category experiences or might experience and which the product has the potential to help with (if the market opportunities are also favourable). One of the most important objectives to set is the key consumer benefit that answers the question: "What is in it for the customer?". A business is essential, but nowadays the condition of its existence is the concentration on the customer and their satisfaction, so this question is as important as inner metrics that the company sets for communication measurement: it defines the direction and quality levels. Defining the level of appropriation

3.3.3 Defining the level of appropriation

In terms of the "how" question, the financial issue is occasionally overlooked. Nevertheless, it is essential at this point to understand the range in which the future expenses that are necessary for achieving goals fall. The stage of defining the level of appropriation doesn't include detailed budget planning, but rather a rough estimation of expected spending. To make this estimation, we need to take a look at competitive strategies budgeting and estimate the needed media usage costs (Paley, 2007).

3.3.4 Formulating the strategy

In this stage, the creative approach is formulated, and the appropriate media is chosen. The strategy on which steps have to be taken to achieve the declared goals. First of all, the marketing mix is identified. As it was stated in the previous part of this work, the marketing mix consists of four "P" - product, price, promotion and place (distribution). In the consumer-oriented society, it makes sense to add the fifth "P" to the classic concept: people. So in this phase, it is needed to determine the product's characteristics, qualities, legal relations and package. The next thing is price: how much the product costs, what are the payment conditions, are there any discounts related. Promotion includes everything related to communicating the product using the best options available. The "Place" option is concerned with the places the product will be available for the customer to see or purchase, and "people" is concerned with the target audience that was pre-research in the first step. It is also involved with any potential contact between the company and the audience that just comes in the first contact with the company.

These days, to achieve results, companies use integrated marketing communication - we have mentioned this one prior. Marketing communication is integrated when it is consistent and optimised with the help of modern technologies to tailor each interaction for each particular receiver. To create and execute a specific integrated strategy, we need to

concentrate primarily on the promotional mix that will correspond not only with the goals of the communication but also with the target's overall knowledge about the company and a product or service. Therefore, different target groups will need different approaches, and there is a need to develop communication with each group accordingly (Blakeman, 2018).

Determining the promotional mix, we chose the main formats and channels of communication. What brings clarity with specific tools is called media mix. Media mix points out specific media tools that would work the best for the set objectives. While the promotional mix is general (for example, we choose between advertisement and direct marketing), in the case of media mix it is needed to specify the methods and tools used (for example, TV, newspaper/magazine advertising or promotional article, a particular social network (e.g. Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Instagram for 2021), guerrilla marketing, public relations, etc.)

As it was mentioned, every target customer in the realm of integrated marketing communication should have its predetermined way of receiving communication. We can divide this target audience into two major categories: the groups of non-customers (those who would try the product or service for the first time, those who are loyal to other brands and those who shift between brands as a result of promotions and price politics) and the group of customers (those who like the brand but would switch for another one once the offer is better and those who are loyal to the brand and would not consider changing it for some other). Then we can differentiate the approaches based on generational (baby boomers, gen x, millennials, gen z or gen alpha) or ethnical (depending on the particular region's peculiarities) features, depending on whether this narrow segmentation is needed in the case of the product/service or not.

Some products are destined to be mainstream and those that are designed for a very specific small group of users (niche marketing is used in this case, it is concentrated on narrowing the target audience).

3.3.5 Strategy integration

The communication strategy should be integrated with the overall company's marketing style and market positioning. The elements of the promotional mix and the messages should be in line with what has been presented prior in general marketing communication. They should coincide with companies' presented values, principles and vision. For example, it might be generally not the best idea to include controversial and provocative elements for a company known for its' conservative values.

3.3.6 Tactical execution: developing a budget

In the case of budgeting, several approaches work depending on the company's size and financial situation. Those are affordable approaches (ignoring the goals and putting as much money as can be afforded, it's mostly about assuming and can not be considered as a real working method, but it might be used when the situation calls for it), part of sales method (it calculates the percentage of expected profit and is widely used because it is simple, but can't be considered effective because it is short-term and ignores the overall business

situation), competitive approach (making the expenses equal to competitors' spending, not working long-term) and objectives approach (based on specifying goals and choosing the tools that ought to be used, it is needed to estimate the cost of fulfilling the chosen tasks) (Paley, 2007).

3.3.7 Legal issues analysis

In this stage, it is necessary to have the main concepts and messages determined to look through them from the perspective of law. Depending on the company's size, it might be done by internal legal staff or external counsel. In case the elements do not meet the law, the adjustment of the strategy or its elements is needed.

3.3.8 Media plan creation

Here, the schedule is being made with the usage of media and communication messages that have been specified prior. Media channels are chosen, and the appropriate content and detailed schedule are being defined in correspondence with predetermined budget allowances.

3.3.9 Strategy review

The final review of the formulated strategy, its messages and objectives, the final revision on all the above-mentioned points is done. If any adjustments are needed, they are made in this phase. It might be useful to engage third-party experts to avoid possible missteps caused by tunnel vision.

3.4 Strategy implementation

Implementation equals "A" step in the SOTAC method, meaning that actions are taken. Depending on the media mix and schedule predetermined in formulating the strategy and media plan creation stages, actions are executed in the right order, with the right messages and content used by people responsible for the process (Blakeman, 2018).

3.5 Evaluation and revision

Marketing communication is considered to be a real investment - not a financial one, but one the company makes to sustain and develop itself. And like with any investment, it is relatively easy to evaluate the result. For that, we use ROI - return on investment - performance measure. It shows what is the ratio between the money spent on the investment and money made with the investment. The next measures are also important, but they are not as concrete: brand awareness levels, how many new customers were made, how does the target group see the product or service, how many people clicked the email (click-through ratio) and many others. This way, the evaluation phase shows whether or not

the goals of the communication have been achieved. Based on the results, the marketing team decides to either continue with the same message or to stop and evaluate why the communication or campaign wasn't successful. It might include analysing marketing communication of the competitors, the message chosen or the target audience's reaction (if needed - why the communication has not reached the target and what should be done to improve it). It might seem like a difficult and subjective process, but the evaluation is the best tool for the understanding of what works or does not work and what should be done about it in the future to improve the outcomes.

3.6 Summary

Marketing communication strategy is a complex business activity that requires planning and thoughtful resource allocation. It is done through such phases as initial research, setting the goals, defining the strategy and creating media plans and budget. The execution follows, and after it, evaluation of the results.

Summary of the theoretical part

In the theoretical part, we have explored the concept of generations and the peculiarities of targeting Gen Z in brand activities. Then, we have analysed marketing communication as an indispensable and indispensable aspect of a company's life, which (in a situation of sufficiently good service) determines attitudes towards the product. Today, marketing communication is often one of the determinants of success: it accompanies and defines every stage of the customer journey. We have described the role of communication, its forms and tools and the latest trends in communication (as of 2021). In this work we drew on the assumption that a situation of over-crowded markets and consumerism raises the question: how to stand out from the competition and win the customer? We have seen that in this day and age it is necessary to make an emotional connection with the customer, especially when it comes to Gen Z. We have seen that brand authenticity is the key to effective communication and that companies need to become "friends" of customers - friends who behave honestly and ethically.

In the second half of the theoretical part, we have discovered a consistent process for planning integrated marketing communication: if a business wants to be effective, its processes need to be streamlined. Marketing communication is no exception and should be planned, regardless of its nature. I have described all the stages of such planning, from the initial collection of information to summarising and determining which aspects should be changed and improved henceforth.

The work carried out in the theoretical part was essential for the issues and challenges of modern marketing and the specifics of building strategies. The theoretical data was used as the basis for the practical component of this project.

Practical part

4 The selected company – Aviasales

4.1 Introduction

The goal of the paper is to create an effective communication style inspired by Aviasales example, yet suitable for the Czech market and one of the companies in a similar field. The pandemic crisis of the travel industry has challenged the companies. The experience of Aviasales shows that an original strategy makes it possible not only to keep the company's current level of prosperity but also to increase it. Using the elements of the Russian startup's strategy might help a company of similar spirit.

The key metric of the project's success is positive feedback from three professionals in the field of marketing and communication, but there is also an intention of implementation of the strategy in the future. The result of the work should be a ready-made set of strategic suggestions that can be recommended to a suitable Czech company.

4.2 Overview

Founded in 2007 by Go Travel Un Limited with its headquarters in Phuket, Aviasales now is one of the world's biggest travel metasearch engines designed to simplify the process of travelling.

Aviasales is a metasearch engine operating in the CIS, Eastern Europe and Africa. In 2007, it was created as a blog of the company's founder Konstantin Kalinov to make travelling easier and cheaper. Today, it is a high-tech service used by 15 million people every month, the Aviasales application is on every third Russian iPhone, roughly 17% of all the flight bookings in Russia originate with it and the gross merchandise sales volume expectations for this year are \$1.6 billion (travolution.com, 2021).

Aviasales finds the most convenient and cost-effective flights in one click: the system analyzes hundreds of offers from sellers. It offers ready-made itineraries: cost-effective tours of several European cities, weekend trips and trips to concerts.

According to Forbes Russia evaluation, the company was 10th in the list of 20 most successful companies in the Russian internet segment and cost \$180 million (Forbes.ru, 2020). Even though the majority of traffic comes from Russian-speaking areas (SimilarWeb.com), Skift magazine considers Aviasales to be "the future of worldwide corporate travel" (Skift, 2020).

In 2019, Aviasales added Uzbekistan, Kyrgyzstan, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Ukraine and Tanzania to its Russian and Kazakh destinations. The number of bookings in the new regions has increased 11-fold, while overall the company's profits have increased by 40%. According to the CPO, Ivan Kozlov, the aim is to create the first globally recognised unicorn

from Russia, and from the latest developments, it is clear that the company management understands what it takes to do so (Aviaport.ru, 2020).

The company was short-listed for the prestigious international PR and Media Measurement Awards AMEC Awards 2017 in two categories at once: "Best use of integrated communication measurement" and "most innovative use of measurement in a digital company" (prexplore.ru, 2017).

4.3 Situation analysis

The success of the company is created by the combination of factors working well together. The product, promotion and people - the elements essential for the success of such a company, since it is not dependent on price and place - are carefully selected and organised.

4.3.1 Product analysis

The products of the company are differentiated by the final customers: being a B2C oriented company, Aviasales started developing B2B products in 2021.

Aviasales provide tickets purchase, there's a partnership program with Booking.com that lets book accommodation simultaneously and the other services that let rent a car or book a tour. The system includes the opportunity to look through all the attractions and popular places of the particular city and even to read the reviews of some local guides. Therefore, Aviasales creates an all-inclusive trip planning user experience, making an effort to surpass the frames of an engine destined exclusively to ticket purchases. It is planned to expand the number of friendly tour guides and photographers to create a community of service providers located in different places. Moreover, in 2021 the company launched the "More" service, which lets users get cashback that is higher than the average market one.

There are directions in the development of B2B: Aviasales offer two solutions for businesses. The service "Aviasales for Business concentrates on work trip planning for corporate clients (vc.ru, 2020). It is a complex tool designed to help managers to be able to book tickets, control costs and track flights in a private account. The webpage allows you to find the best route and cost for a business trip and plan several trips simultaneously. According to the company, the service will make it possible to better organise the paperwork and save managers' time.

Another decision in the B2B area is Aviastats Business Intelligence service (prezly.com, 2021). The service is created for airline companies, travel agencies and airports to make it easier to come up with new routes and have a better understanding of revenue management based on the search statistics that are composed of search queries. The Vice President of Aviasales Revenue Management, Yaroslav Kotyshov, claims that the collected data helps to track and anticipate market trends and forecast the needs of the clients, which is vital.

4.3.2 Target audience research

According to the company's advertising media kit (aviasales.ru, 2017), their clients are "wealthy adults who continue to travel in all conditions and are modern enough to plan their trips on their own". Customers choose Aviasales primarily because of the algorithms that provide convenient offers: low prices, convenient connections. Next is the choice of brand because of modern, clear and attractive communication. Aviasales products and communication are oriented towards middle and upper-class individuals who are capable of critical thinking and reasoning and do not rely on travel agencies or other intermediaries. The client base consists primarily of people aged 25-34, then 18-24 and 35-44, males slightly prevailing. There are different segments in the target audience (for example, the company's Instagram's main target is women).

4.3.3 Competition analysis

Aviasales is the biggest company in the segment of travel metasearch engines in Russia, the second one is Scottish Skyscanner (vedomosti.ru, 2017). The further competitions are such metasearch engines as Yandex (Russian alternative of Google) and Google flights, but they are concentrated on ticket search only and do not include additional services (gazeta.ru, 2017). According to the company's CEO Max Kraynov, the broader competition includes more companies, for example, Leroy Merlin - in the times of COVID crisis, technically, anyone with Aviasales is competing for the "customer's wallet (interfax.ru, 2021). According to him, every sixth ticket in Russia is bought through Aviasales, but the overall interest for travelling is dropping due to pandemic and the main goal becomes not to sell tickets, but to keep customers and travelling-oriented mindset in the broader audience, and that is achieved with the right branding and communication.

5 Analysis of the company's communication

5.1 Introduction

In order to better understand the selected company and understand what makes it stand out, let's take a closer look at its marketing communication.

Product and promotion (two “P”s out of four) play key roles in the success of a company that provides services not bonded to a place and a price. I suggest that these days promotion needs to be authentic. The authenticity is shown in many ways: for example, political topics are used and commented on in a witty and mocking manner, and that performs outstandingly in the conditions of the political situation in Russia.

The idea here is not to maximise the profit but to create such brand awareness that will occupy the market first and win the customer in future. It is reflected in all aspects of marketing, from SMM and newsletters to paid YouTube integrations, there is consistency and the ability to position oneself as a modern company that stays true

to its values.

For research purposes, I conducted a survey of the target audience. A total of 157 people from 17 to 40 years of age took part in the survey.

According to the survey I've conducted,

- 90% of the respondents of 18-40 years old were familiar with the brand and could explain its main activity was. The attitude of the respondents varied between “neutral” and “positive” and there were no respondents who considered their attitude towards Aviasales to be negative.
- 82% of the respondents reported that their knowledge of the brand is based on the smart and unique advertisement on social media and the ingenious paid integrations in YouTube videos; the rest reported getting to know about the company through word of mouth (through friends, colleagues and relatives).
- 12% of the respondents reported knowing the company from the physical advertisements in airports as well as from the previously mentioned sources.
- 68% use the service while planning their trips.

According to Glazova's analysis (2021) of the company's metrics, there's also a direct correlation between the controversial social media posts, their media exposure and website traffic. Based on this data, I suggest that Aviasales communication strategy might be considered as successful.

5.2 Branding

Aviasales is a start-up, and from the beginning, it has adhered to the principles of immediacy, openness and sincerity in its communication. The CEO of the company believes that "craziness" is one of the factors in the creative success of a project. According to him, "Aviasales employs people who are crazy in a good fashion. Those who can do things that would not even occur to a normal person. <....> They can make jokes about Navalny and Putin, but they are very correct and don't make jokes about grief, about those who are in danger - these are basic human rules." A strictly rational person would create a logical and understandable product that would be emotionally blank. And the craziness of the right kind is just the opposite of that (gq.ru, 2018). Freedom and originality are essential for the brand, as are open-mindedness, truthfulness and bravery in its communication.

The brand resembles the archetype of the jester - it is fun, humorous and smart, but sometimes might be considered as edgy and disrespectful (thehartford.com, 2021).

5.3 The unique selling proposition

A large percentage of the company's success and recognition among people is the result of a new way of looking at brand communication. The main theme of the company's communication is travelling, and that is not very unique. Yet, the way they communicate the topic is quite unusual. For example, when the dollar went up in 2014 and airfares followed it, the company urged followers on social media to buy tickets at the old prices. This not only increased sales to foreign destinations by 45% but also created an image of a friendly brand that helps in an uncertain situation. Aviasales managed to create an emotional connection with the audience. According to Janis Zenis, the company's Head of Communications, the average user purchases flight tickets one and a half times a year. Content marketing aims to rather achieve more frequent and lasting contact with the audience than to sell more tickets at the given moment. The communication strives to build an emotional connection, it might be any type of reaction - even if the user responds to a newsletter about cats with the picture of their cat.

According to Janis, nowadays, it is not enough for a brand to be just "well-built" - it is important that there is empathy between users and the company. Such a brand is more trusted and thus is more frequently chosen. Sometimes the communication of such kind is perceived as controversial, provocative or offensive, but the company representative indicates that there is never an intention to disturb anyone. By using plain and direct language, the only reflects the reality that surrounds it. The conducted poll shows that participants associate Aviasales primarily with cheap tickets, creativity, out-of-the-box thinking, memes and brave policy. Participants call them "down to earth" and "our people", mentioning also that they are a trustworthy source of information. Considering that Russian-speaking society is extremely polarised these days (ridl.io, 2020) and due to autocratic politics (swp.org, 2021), those who are sincere and open about the current political situation are considered brave and trustworthy among politically and socially-

active middle-class youth. Aviasales wins the sympathy of a significant part of its target audience.

Aviasales case is unique in its absence of limits: Aviasales is an internet-only company, which means that, firstly, the traffic on the site is real customers; secondly, they don't have to worry about the reaction from the side of the state authorities; and thirdly, an audience that travels a lot and is used to surfing the internet understands this humour. The PR person for some conservative company would never be able to afford this. Nevertheless, such elements of the branding as sincerity and striving to appear authentic can't harm a business in the long run.

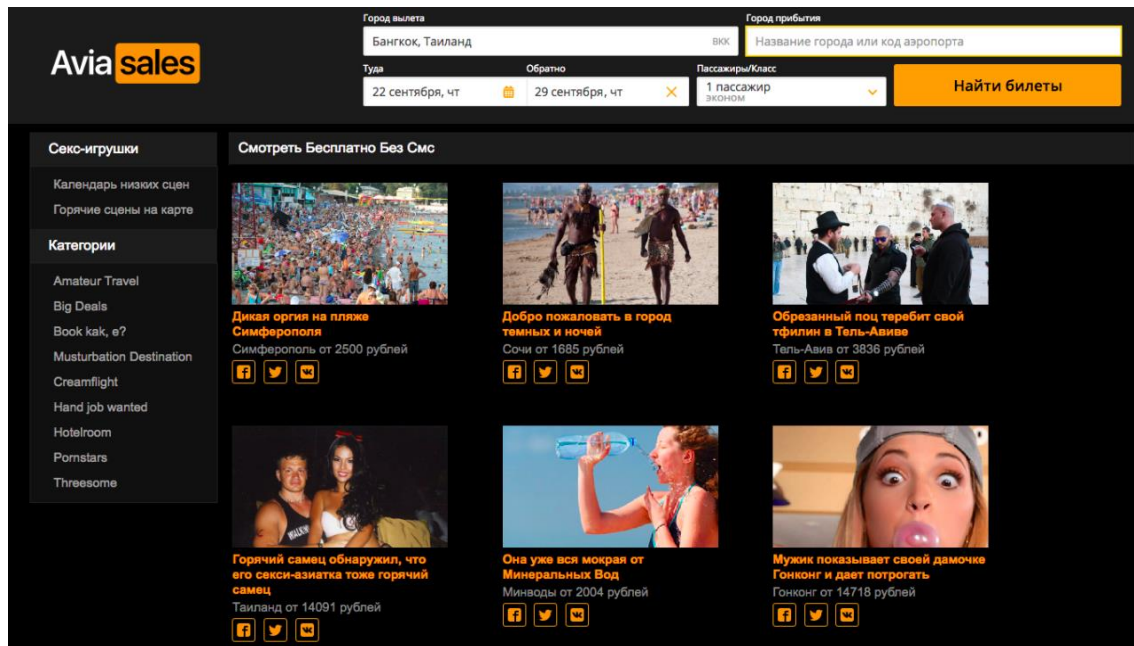
5.4 Communication mix

5.4.1 Introduction

The promotional mix consists primarily of low-cost tools such as social networks channels, but there are also such expensive components as a physical advertisement (both indoors and outdoors) and paid Youtube promotions. A big part of the content is situational: it reacts to a situation that has emerged recently. The company does not aim to attract more followers on social media - it focuses on the media reach. A reach of more than 100,000 users is considered good. To achieve a greater reach, the company collaborates with bloggers: more often these are long-term partnerships rather than one-off ad placements.

Aviasales uses every possible social network: Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, VK, Telegram. The company was among the first to embrace TikTok and Clubhouse. The company runs its blog with travel tips and up-to-date information on how to travel during the covid (aviasales.ru, 2021).

The situational humour approach is controversial, but this risk often generates enormous benefits. A great example of that might be the case when Aviasales reacted to blocking Pornhub by the Russian government in 2016. The company has created a stylised landing page similar to a blocked resource but called One-Left Flight Search, and popular destinations have been named: "Welcome to the City of Darkness and Nights", "A Man Shows His Lady Hong Kong and Gives Her a Touch", and others. A click on the picture takes the visitor to a page with ticket prices. "The project itself generated sales of over a million roubles and attracted around half a million visitors without any advertising. According to research by PR News, 30% of Aviasales' audience notices similar stories and the share of loyal ones [willing to recommend, use] is much higher," said the Head of PR department (amocrm.ru, 2017).



Picture 1: the situational marketing. Source: (vc.ru)

5.4.2 Physical advertising

Physical advertising in the standard brand sense is rare but accurate. For example, this advertisement was placed in airport toilets - it is not difficult to find it on the internet because it caused a public reaction. Despite those who say that such humour is not funny at all, a significant number of commentators support the creativity, boldness and experimental nature of the ad.



Picture 2: the use of the advertisement in the airport of Krasnodar. Source: (Yandex Zen)



Picture 3: "We'll find a plane ticket before you're done". Source: (Yandex Zen)



Picture 4: "Oh, wow, you take it with you or put into your luggage?". Source: (Yandex Zen)

The other type of advertisement is the outdoors one, and there is a great example of it. It is also purely situational.

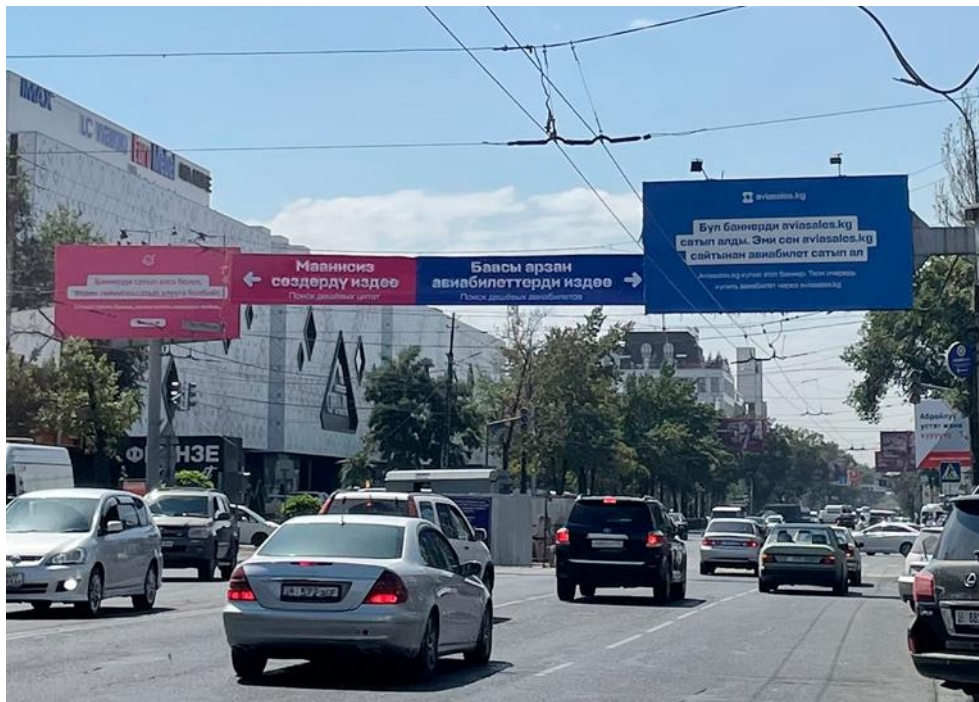
A little later, across the street, Bookit put up a banner saying 'You can buy a banner, but you can't buy people's love'.



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Then, another banner from Aviasales.kg appeared between the two billboards as a pointer between the two banners saying: "←Search for cheap quotes | Search for cheap airfares→"

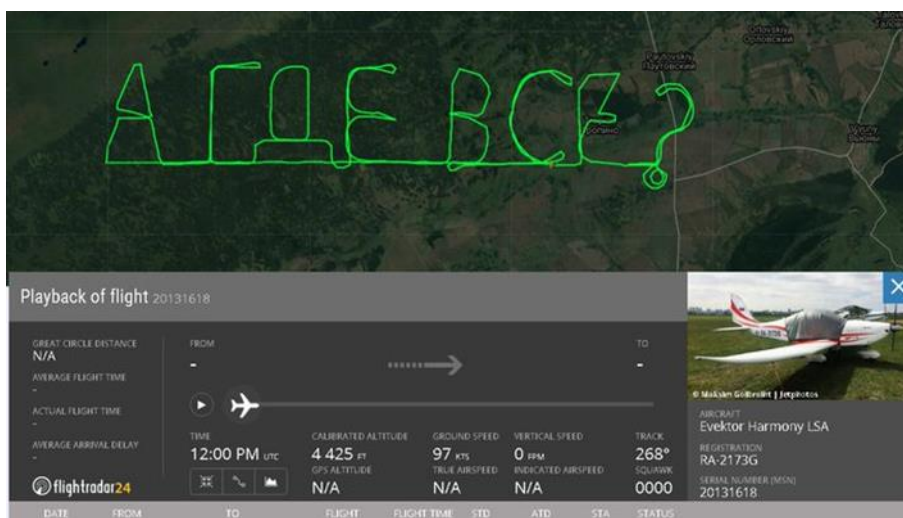
(ekonomist.kg, 2021)



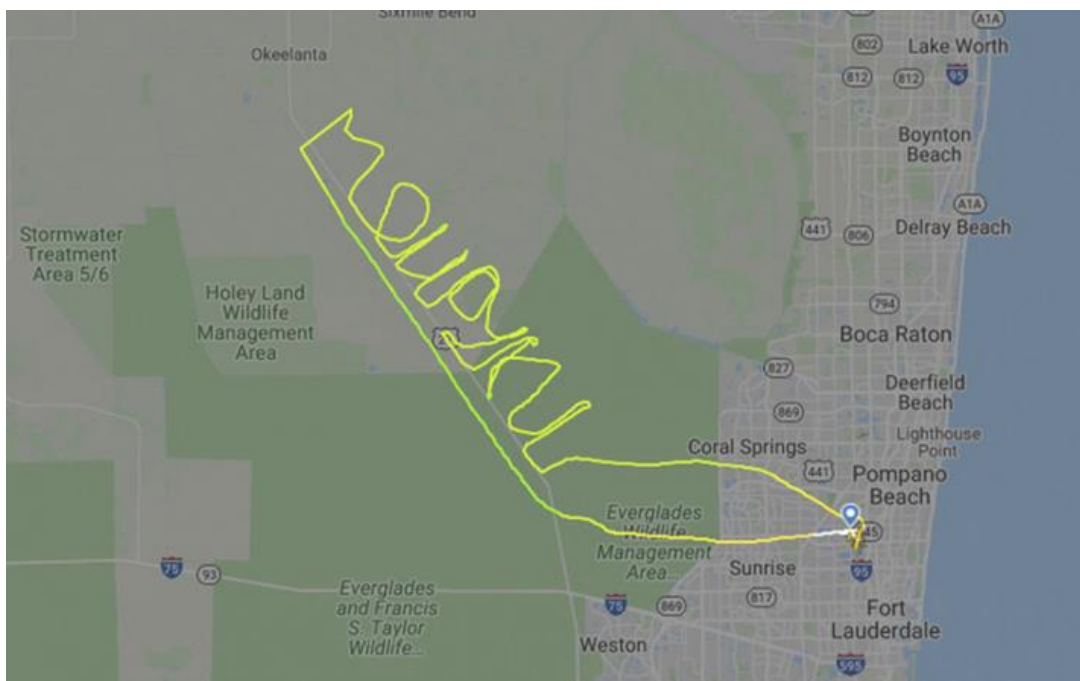
Picture 7: the third banner. Source: (ekonomist.kg)

The best example is yet to come. This case appeared in times of the first COVID lockdown when it was uncertain yet what to expect from the new reality.

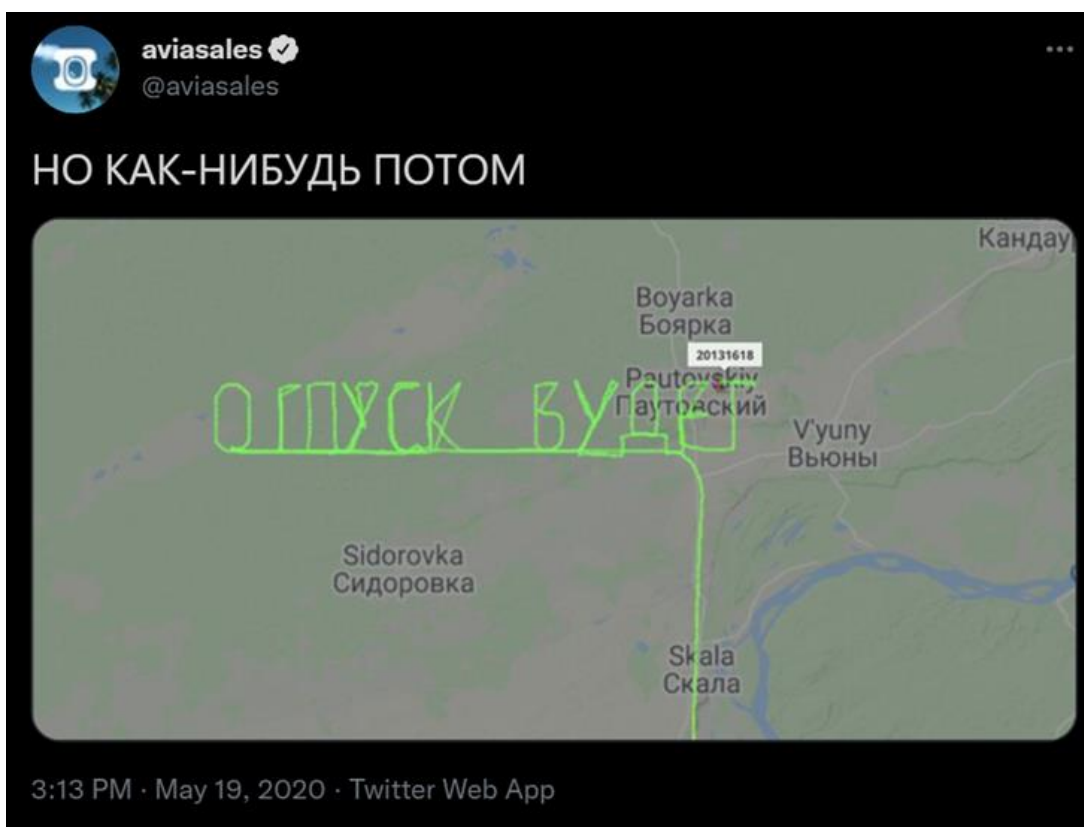
For a week in May 2020, pilots from Russia and the US left mysterious messages in the sky: "WHERE IS EVERYONE?", "WASH HANDS" and "THE VACATION WILL BE" were seen in FlightRadar. It turned out that all three inscriptions were advertisements within the Aviasales pandemic campaign "Travel. But sometime later" (adindex.ru, 2020).



Picture 8: "Where is everyone?". Source: (Twitter)

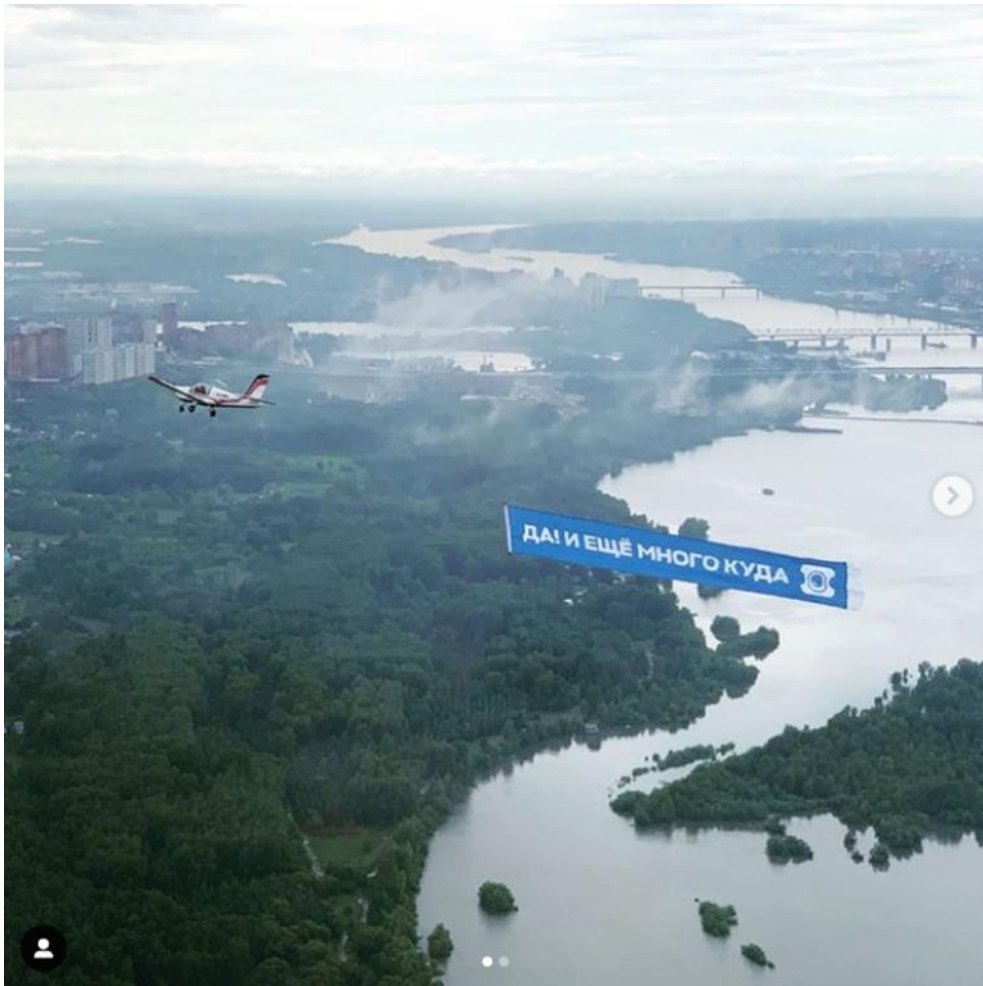


Picture 9: "Wash hands". Source: (sostav.ru)



Picture 10: "Vacation will be. BUT SOMETIME LATER". Source: (Twitter)

Another similar case comes with the post of Russian businesswoman Natalia Ilyina from Novosibirsk who had planned a holiday in Greece and asked if she could go there. She received a response from the plane: "Yes! And many more places". Several more planes with "signs from above" answered questions in Kazan and Ufa.



Picture 11: "Yes! And many other places". Source: (Instagram)

The examples provided were associated with anything but traditional ways of advertising a service or product. They resonated online and were received positively: it's not every day that the public sees advertising integration at a height of 1,500 feet. These are examples of the way Aviasales uses current situations to contribute to brand recognition and relationships. These ideas don't have to be that expensive if you take a look at their social networks communication.

5.4.3 Blog

Aviasales posts articles, games and polls that are then used in the posts and messages in the social networks posts and messages. The company's blog has some interesting catchy headlines, like "How to get fat in 5 days: a guide to Yerevan" or "Las Vegas: how not to spend a lot of money and beat the casino". A lot of social media posts are published with links to the blog and these are the ones that stimulate most of the reactions from travellers.

Page managers actively communicate with users, often with jokes, which again stimulate activity on their pages.

The main topics on the Aviasales social media are as follows:

- Tips for travellers.
- Guides to cities and countries.
- News in the travel sector concerning Russian tourists.
- Hot offers to stimulate consumption.

The PR News survey covered 1,000 people from different regions of Russia: 33% of them had seen the posts by Aviasales, most of them were positive or neutral (40% and 46% respectively), while only 14% expressed a negative attitude. 11% said they were ready to give up on the service because of such publications, while 14%, on the other hand, paid attention to the site and decided to give it a try.

5.4.4 Social networks

Facebook - 237.5k followers, VK - 293.8k followers

Facebook and VK (the main Russian network) management is similar: posts appear once or twice a day, primarily news and blog articles. Managers often ask users to share tips and experiences, engaging them in communication and creating a connection.

Instagram - 303k followers

Photo content on Instagram is mostly personal photos of users who tag Aviasales in their posts, as well as photos of bloggers the aggregators collaborate with. In the posts, the company encourages its readers to tag their travel photos with #aviasales_bloggers.

Telegram - 58.9k followers

Messenger is primarily used to spread news, blog posts and urgent information that may be relevant to those who are travelling at the moment. For example, the service kept users informed about the latest news related to the spread of the new strain of the coronavirus.

Twitter - 107.6k followers

According to the company's PR director, Twitter is an experimental platform where they test content. The element that Aviasales uses most often is situational content. Most often it's about memes on current topics. As SMM manager Roman Bordunov points out, such content above all works for recognition: people will not go straight to buy tickets, but they will remember the brand, not the competitor. Witty humour also generates an increase in media mentions: it is written about on other platforms, re-posted, mentioned in posts and Instagram Stories. According to statistics, in the third quarter of 2020 alone, the company gained 8 million views on Twitter this way (support.travelpayouts.com, 2020).



Picture 12: "When you saved on tickets and could afford the watch". Source: (Twitter)

Context: Meme reaction to the investigation into the Russian press secretary's 37 million-ruble watch, posted in the middle of a social scandal on the topic.



Picture 13: "The reason to travel №2348534: to explore the world and see the world's most beautiful palaces with your own eyes". Source: (Twitter)

Context: the third picture shows the palace of the Russian president discovered in 2021 by the opposition and hotly discussed within the society, it's estimated cost is 100 billion rubbles and the source of the money remains unknown (supposedly, corruption).

The key aspect here is the ability to respond quickly to events or social media responses in a funny way to create complex emotionally connected communication. There's a great example:

“- I can't do anything. Will you take me? (for a job)

- We have SMM already”



Picture 14: "We have SMM manager already". Source: (Twitter)

It is important to be up to date. For example, when there was NFT hype, the company offered to sell the first tweet inspired by the example of Jack Dorsey for 0,2021 ETH (adindex.ru, 2021).

TikTok - 67.7k followers

TikTok is one of the company's new channels, which is just starting to develop and is looking for its format. The communication is aimed at younger users, but the general direction remains: for example, the service used another political occasion in 2021. Many of the platform's paid video bloggers were engaged in anti-protest propaganda, recording videos saying "no revolution, no need to go to protests, you all know what that can lead to". Aviasales has also released a video message to children in its TikTok account calling for them to "say no to revolution". In the video, the brand warns children against downloading the Aviasales app and "unauthorised, uncoordinated searches for cheap flights". "There is no point in engaging in this. As these actions can lead to aggressive travel. You can even fly out of Russia", says the heroine of the video (adindex.ru, 2021).

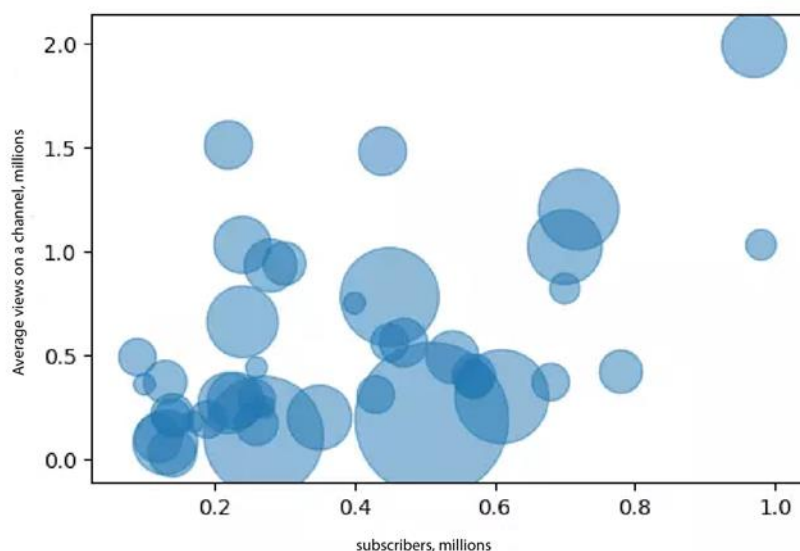
5.4.5 Email marketing

Aviasales's email newsletter is well-known and is often set as an example for those wishing to create useful emails. These emails are light, with catchy headlines, and beautiful illustrations: don't overburden the recipient but offer an interesting journey. In emails, the company answers readers' questions first, then gives ideas and shares the latest news. This creates a sense of dialogue and increases the percentage of times emails are opened (mailfit.com, 2019). The usual email includes two sections: articles (advice, ideas, news, stories) and answers to the questions. There's an option to ask any question about travelling in the bottom part of the email.

5.4.6 Paid promotion on YouTube

The company was one of the first to recognise the true potential of YouTube advertising. Instead of stifling bloggers with requirements about where and what advertising should be, the company chooses bloggers whose audience matches their target audience and gives them free rein. Advertising becomes casual, out-of-the-box - the kind that an overloaded user would listen to. the aim of such advertising is not to increase profits momentarily, but to make the company the only one that comes to mind the moment a potential customer needs the service.

The main topics of the channels are comedy and travelling, the news segment is also involved, but it's not very successful; there have been more than ten integrations on Youtube every month since the beginning of 2020 (vc.ru, 2020). Aviasales advertises with both established bloggers and small, undeveloped channels that have high average views - this is how analysts identify future trending channels early on:



Picture 15: the choice of bloggers. Source: (vc.ru, SuperPromoData)

The estimated budget for Youtube integration (based on 0.2 rub/view) for 2019-2020 is 66 million rubles (20 million Czech crowns) (vc.ru).

Compared to other tools that "parasitise" on current events, this one is expensive, but it has contributed to Aviasales becoming a household name that everyone with access to the internet knows about - even those who don't use it. Because of the unobtrusive advertising in a huge number of videos, a positive connection is formed, and I'm sure this, in addition to all the other channels, defines the attitude towards the company among young prospects. This assumption is confirmed by the research I conducted: it showed that the vast majority of young respondents not only know the brand (90%) but feel good about it (69.5%) and use its services (68%). In short, communication is doing its job.

5.5 Summary

In the communication breakdown I have given you, you can see that the company uses a huge number of communication channels. In each of these channels, the company tries to find unconventional approaches and to win the customer with authenticity.

6 Czech metasearch engines market research

6.1 Introduction

Metasearch is often considered the best solution for travel planning: it allows people to combine several phases of the complex search and booking process into a straightforward sequence. It aggregates information that the customer would not have been able to analyse on their own and finds the best offer. When this is supplemented by positives such as reduced ticket prices or accommodation bookings, the “points” are added up. This is not surprising, as finding really good options these days is more like a separate art form or specialisation (loudavymkrokem.cz, 2020).

6.2 The analysis of local search engines

Both global players (Skyscanner, Kiwi, Momondo, Google Flights) and local players (Letuška, zaletsi, cestujlevne.com) are popular in the Czech market. There are other ones, like “Honzovy letenky”, that have potential but occupy a rather small market share to be considered a real competition at the moment. The further competition extends to any company providing and mediating travelling opportunities: carriers, travel agencies or even carpooling companies.

6.3 The choice of the right company

In my intention to adopt elements of the chosen brand strategy, I decided not to focus on the global giants of the field: such defiant and bold marketing is not suitable for a global corporation with a strict, unified culture that does not allow for individual freedom - this is the 'price' for its size and effectiveness. Agreeing with the PR head of Aviasales, I think that such marketing, though effective, is not suitable for everyone: only local companies with a high level of freedom. A company that can afford to identify with one main expressed audience: young, progressive people who will be able to appreciate such marketing and "befriend" the company, distinguishing it as a leader in the field - and never mind that there are bigger players.

In conjunction with this, we are talking about a local Czech firm that has a pronounced demand for working with young people and at the same time the freedom to act boldly, because the company is not burdened by its size and commitments to public investors - a private company with a start-up spirit that can afford to experiment. When choosing a company, I considered Letuška.cz and Student Agency, but the first one gives the

impression of a serious, classic company, for which stability is more important than experimentation, so the second was chosen.

Student Agency is not solely dedicated to airline ticketing services, but focuses on a large portfolio of travel-related ones: arranging buses and trains connections, tours and ensuring working trips (studentagency.cz, 2021) through several subsidiaries. Nevertheless, founded by a student, it represents the striving for development and creative ideas within the travel sector in the Czech Republic. For example, 2016 Student Agency's "unconventional" campaign is known: the company has placed photos and phone numbers of politicians on the backs of buses to protest and inspire residents to contact the people in charge about their grievances and not to remain silent (idnes.cz, 2016).



Picture 16: the bus back. Source: (idnes.cz)

The company is widely known on the market and is one of the leaders in the segment, and its advertisements are visible everywhere. But the Barvířová (2020) survey shows that the majority of respondents would prefer the company's communication and advertising to take place on the internet and social media, but without the use of e-mail. Bílková (2011) evaluates brand communication as being one-size-fits-all and everywhere, and sees this as a big disadvantage. Another big disadvantage is that it is challenging to research the company since it's not published its financial statements since 2017. Yet, the current time can be understood as a reason for re-evaluation and bold decisions - a partial change in communication may move the company forward.

7 The communication strategy project

7.1 Introduction

The example of Aviasales demonstrates a company that is not afraid, to be honest, authentic and controversial. I think this is an extreme case, and to go that far would require dedicating the whole identity of the company to it, which clearly would not work in the case of Student Agency: it is a mature, established brand whose history spans almost thirty years. Fortunately, you don't have to become a replica of a successful Russian start-up: just look closely at a few key ideas that have the potential to improve brand perception and customer loyalty even especially in tough times.

Also, as Aviasales' head of PR cautions, marketing in this way is only part of the service, which has to be perfect: product, branding, performance, human resources must run like clockwork. Otherwise, open-mindedness will be associated with slackness and irresponsibility (prexplore.ru, 2017).

7.2 Communication strategy planning

In this work, I suppose that the goal of any company, as it was stated by Milton Friedman, is to develop and maximize profits while reducing costs. According to the company's CEO Radim Jančura (Šrutková, 2014), the narrower objective is to provide the best services for the lowest price. The improvement of the current communication is likely to improve the quality of the services.

7.3 SOSTAC method

SOSTAC is a widely used method of marketing planning that stands for six steps (smartinsights.com, 2021):

- Situation analysis ("Where is the company now?")
- Objectives ("Where the company wants/can be?")
- Strategy ("How to get there?")
- Tactics ("What are the particular steps?")
- Action ("What is the plan?")
- Control ("Did we get there?")

7.4 The company's situation analysis

7.4.1 PEST and SWOT analysis

PEST is the system for evaluating external factors that influence the operation of the company (my analysis):

- P - political and law

The political situation in the country creates a comfortable enough environment for doing business. According to the World Bank, the Czech Republic overall rate is 76.3% with high indicators in the areas of registering property, taxes paying, trading across borders and resolving insolvency. Yet, the current situation is highly unstable caused by the global pandemic and constantly changing travelling rules and restrictions.

- E – economic

The Czech Republic's GDP was evolving since 2008 and the economy was growing, yet these days the COVID crisis has caused a drop in the world's economy, the Czech Republic is not being excluded (data.worldbank.org, 2021). Some economists expect a further decline.

- S – social

The situation of the pandemic harms society: life becomes uncertain, there is no long-term planning, people are prone to negative outlooks, and expectations of a marked decline in the economy add to anxiety. These circumstances harm the travel sector because it is a luxury product and not a necessity.

- T – technological

The technological situation only improved during the pandemic: many services moved to the digital world and it became apparent that businesses needed to be short on technology to survive - this gave the industry a quantum leap (deloitte.com)

SWOT analysis gives us the perspective on the business from several points of view (Barvířová, 2020):

Strengths:

- The brand is highly recognised, a leader in the field
- Online services
- Price policy
- Integrated and recognised visual style, strong associations

Weaknesses:

- The complexity of the services, overloaded web pages
- Identity of style with RegioJet's subsidiary, which creates ambiguity
- Excessive typical advertisement
- Drop in the quality of the provided services (2020-2021)
- The financial statements have not been published since 2017

Opportunity:

- The end of the pandemic, that would allow travelling and visiting cultural events
- The economic growth
- Globalisation and interest in travelling and getting international work experience

Threats:

- The continuation of the COVID crisis and uncertainty
- Further restrictions
- Political changes (e.g. Brexit) that change the status of other countries and the processes of travelling/study stays
- Increase in the terrorist attacks cases - possible fear of travelling
- Decrease in the economy causing increased costs and lowered interest in travelling
- Expansion of a big international player or development of local competitors (e.g. FlixBus)

7.4.2 Product analysis

The product portfolio is very big, but it all is connected to travelling: leisure or work, short or long term, by plane or by bus. The main ones are airline ticketing, bus and train travel (RegioJet), language and work travel, package holidays (dovolena.cz), business trip organisation.

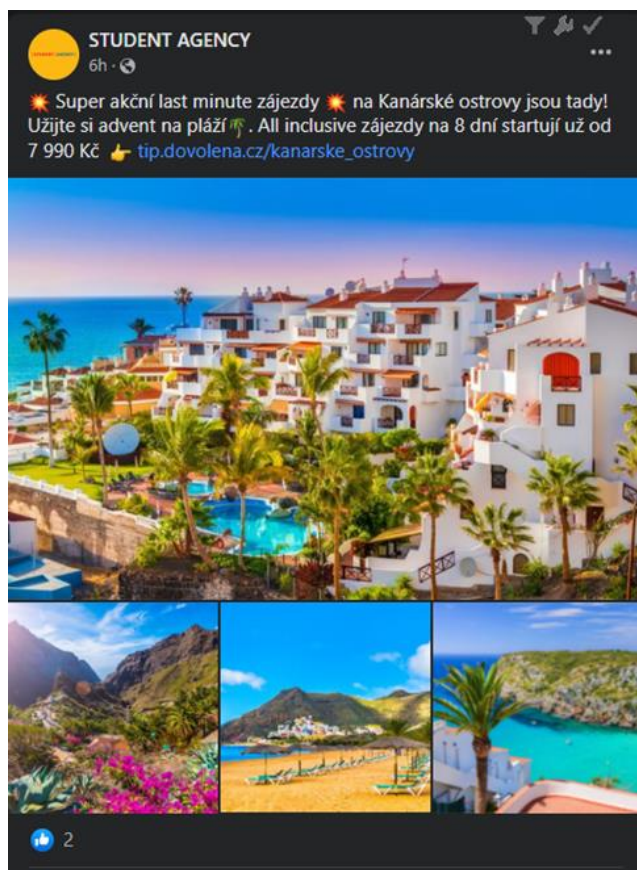
7.4.3 Communication mix analysis

The physical advertisements of each sub-company of the holding company are different, but they all look similar. Physical advertisement is very common and widely recognized, it can be met anywhere and usually promotes particular sales.

Social networks are not differentiated or targeted, they all ignore the existence of customers (either good or bad comments are left without an answer).

Facebook - 52k followers

The amount of followers has great potential which is not used - posts are rarely liked more than by 10 people, which means that 99.98% of followers are indifferent to the updates that are full of similar bright pictures and lack of appealing information (just the promotion of the trips).



Picture 17: an example of a post. Source: (facebook)



Picture 18: an example of a post. Source: (facebook)



Picture 19: an example of a post. Source: (facebook)

Instagram - 2.9k followers

Instagram is standardised and not personal, there's no working content, no information, no communication with the commentators.

LinkedIn -7.5k followers

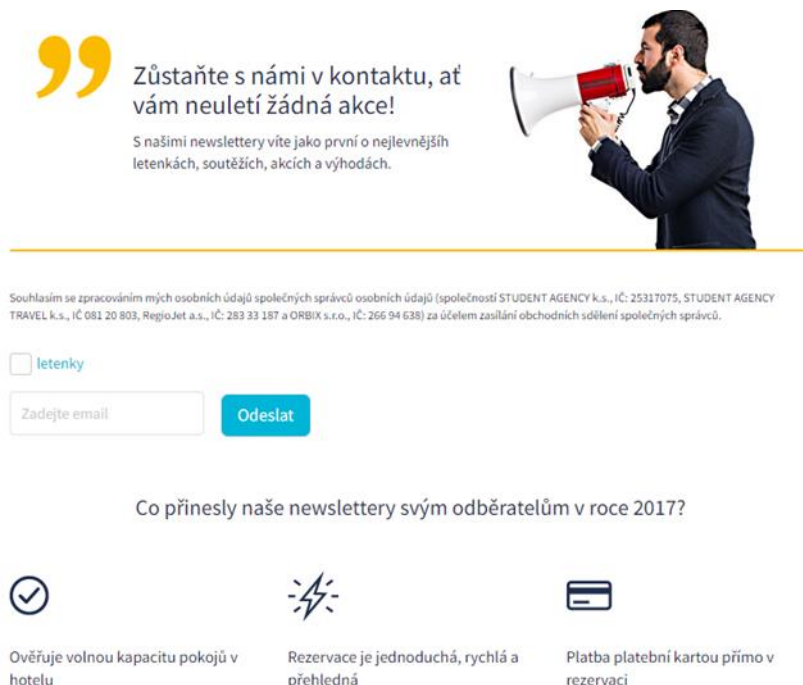
Internship travel opportunities are displayed a lot, but they are primarily targeted at language teachers and LinkedIn is mostly about corporate people and B2B interaction/networking. The offers collect 5-8 likes, the potential is not used.

Other social networks

Neither Twitter nor TikTok, which might help to create communication with clients, is not developed

Email marketing

It was difficult to find how to apply for the newsletter and when I did find it, the page was outdated. No email would inform the recipient about the subscription and the future remains quite uncertain.



” Zůstaňte s námi v kontaktu, ať vám neuletí žádná akce!

S našimi newslettery víte jako první o nejlevnějších letenkách, soutěžích, akcích a výhodách.

☐ letenky

Co přinesly naše newslettery svým odběratelům v roce 2017?

 Ověřuje volnou kapacitu pokojů v hotelu	 Rezervace je jednoduchá, rychlá a přehledná	 Platba platební kartou přímo v rezervaci
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Picture 20: "What have our newsletters brought their readers in 2017?". Source: (studentagency.cz)

7.4.4 The target audience in the Czech Republic

Despite the company's name, which was intended as a student internship provider, these days it is not only students whom the company tries to win.

Due to the abundance of workstreams, it is difficult to identify a common target audience. For mobility vehicles, this is pretty much everyone who goes anywhere. For the trainees and work opportunities, it is young, educated people in search of international experience. In the case of B2B services, these are companies whose employees travel for work.

Nevertheless, because of the name and tradition, the focus on the young customer, for whom getting to the destination of travel is more important than expensive comfort, remains. Along with this orientation comes the need to understand the specifics of today's young people. As mentioned earlier, the market is overflowing with the offer of competing companies these days, and the personal relationship with the customer often becomes a decisive factor in the success of a company's communication. Today's young - late millennials and Generation Z - are used to the information noise and incomprehensible flow of services and products being sold. To win their trust, you have to be honest and interesting with them and to do that you have to speak their language.

7.5 The objectives

The ultimate goal of the communicational update is to create a deeper emotional connection with the customer, which is likely to be essential these days. The main idea is to become more interesting, personal and authentic with the customers. Such an abstract goal can be achieved using the SMART planning technique: making goals specific, measurable, achievable, relatable and time-bonded.

The set objectives aim to test the assumption that the change of communication might improve the level of interaction with the audience and potentially increase the number of loyal customers in the face of the COVID crisis.

S - to improve social media communication

M - to increase followers by 25% and the engagement rates by 50% minimum

A - change the posts tone, topics, structure

R - in the manner interconnected with the brand main vision, yet more personal and engaging

T - two quarters of the year (enough to see whether the supposed strategy is working or not)

7.6 Strategical suggestions

The brand archetype is the jester, humorous and flamboyant, not aiming for chic and luxury - on the contrary, offering unique, cheap but still comfortable service. Accordingly, the brand's advertising should be in a similar vein: you can use humour and fun as an association with exceptionally low prices. This humour can be situational and relate to the current situation in society and politics (but not be offensive). In this way, humorously, by advising based on the topic of modern travel, by engaging in dialogue, the company can become not just a service provider, but a true friend to the customer in the volatile world of the covid pandemic.

7.6.1 Physical advertisement

The physical advertising with which the brand is associated is usually owned by subsidiaries, so there will be no suggestions for improvement in this paper.

7.6.2 Social networks

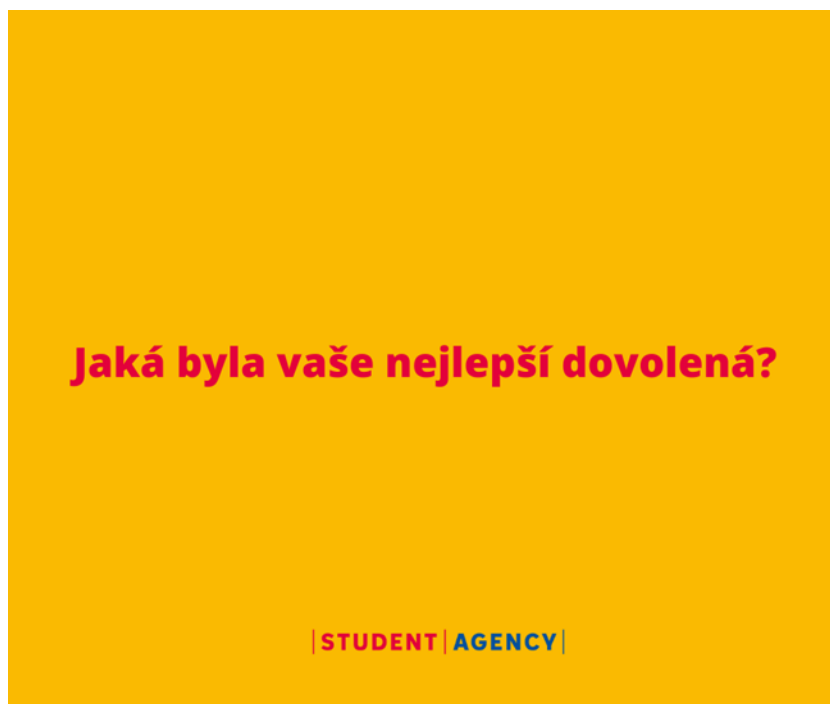
First and foremost: customers should receive feedback for the commentaries. Good or bad, they have to have an answer, that should go without saying.

Then, the social media of such a big player on the travel market can become the leading provider of up-to-date information for Czech-speaking travellers: what is the state of travel, what steps are taken to combat the new Coronavirus strain, what updates the airlines have. You can help travellers with planning and travel relief by reminding them of Student Agency travel insurance, which can significantly alleviate the anxiety that causes many people not to attempt to go anywhere. Current Student Agency communication encourages clients to want to travel. The main problem today is not that people don't want to - there is a perception that the unpredictability of the world makes it too difficult to travel. Clients need a reliable travel companion who assures them that their trip will go well.

It might also be useful to interconnect Student Agency, dovolena.cz and RegioJet communication on social networks - or at least make it seem like there is the same background behind these social media profiles (apart from outdated showy design)

Facebook

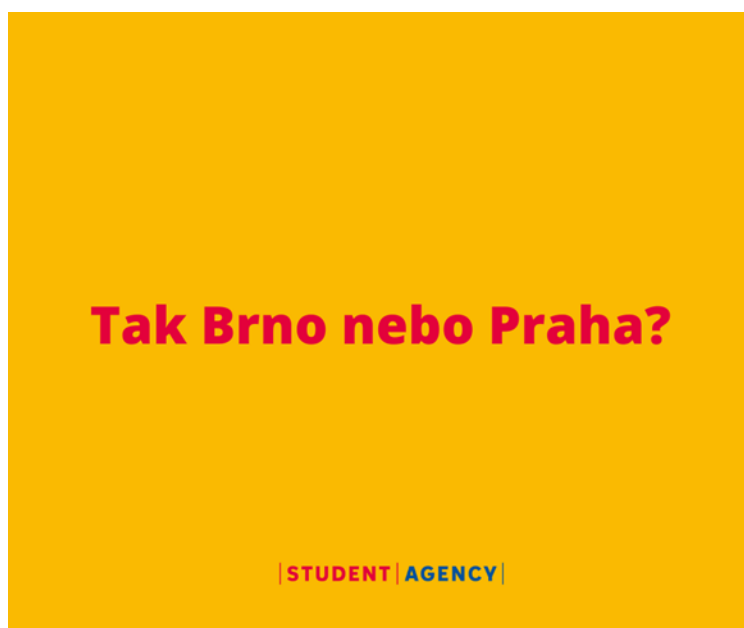
Facebook is the company's most developed channel. It can be used as the main one as recommended earlier. Examples of possible posts that can create activity and engagement:



Picture 21: "What your best vacation was like?". Source: (own design)



Picture 23: The post about COVID updates. Source: (own design).



Picture 22: "So Brno or Prague?". Source: (own design)

The content doesn't have to be political or controversial right away: we talk about being authentic, personal and non-standard.

Instagram

Instagram is a good platform for specific interaction with the audience. For example, you could make a hashtag specifically for customers' journeys - so that when they share positive impressions of the service, it could be used for cheap advertising: the posts would appear in the account and could be reposted.

LinkedIn

It would make sense to leave student internship offers for Facebook and instead promote specialised work internships and Orbix service that helps managers to organise work trips.

Other social networks:

It would pay off to have a Twitter account to communicate with people easier and react faster. It would require to be constantly present and responsive because of the social network specifics.

It would be useful to explore native advertisements on YouTube through bloggers, not Youtube itself (usual advertisements are easily turned off with Youtube Premium or AdBlocker or just ignored as white noise). The influencers, whose channels and personalities would get along with the company's profile: Adam Mach (242k followers), Kovy (860k followers), Kryštof Paleta (37.4k followers).

7.7 Schedule and budget

This strategy has no time frame, but you should count on active social media when planning: a minimum of two Facebook posts a day (there may be more depending on the world situation), an Instagram post once a few days and daily stories that also inform people about the latest news, unique service offerings.

The biggest regular expenditure in this kind of management could be the maintenance of an SMM specialist, ideally for each social network. According to platy.cz, the salary of an SMM specialist is between 28 and 60 thousand crowns per month. The biggest pitfall in this is finding a good specialist (or specialists) who will understand the humour and thinking of the target audience: the humour and thinking of generation Z are very specific (affinitymagazine.us, 2020), and one should work with them coming from the same generation. We are talking about a rather unconventional, creative person. According to Aviasales manager, very often companies misuse memes and jokes, and that might damage the company's image (secretmag.ru, 2017).

In the case of advertisements placed with Influencers on YouTube, payment is calculated on the basis of the views the YouTuber's video accumulates. Summed, it can go up to millions of crowns - depending on the company's cost/benefit analysis.

7.8 Supposed key metrics for the controlling and evaluation

To determine the success of communication, I suggest using several metrics: first of all, engagement, exposure to posts, success among different demographics. Also the number of likes, shares and comments on posts - they indicate the degree of audience engagement in communicating with the brand.

The second metric is the number of subscribers. But it should be assessed not as an absolute value, but as a relative one - by how many more people follow us than yesterday?

The next indicator of success is media attention, evaluation by experts, and the number of mentions of the company's communication and marketing.

7.9 Summary

My analysis of the original communication and proposal aims to show that successful marketing in this day and age requires a fundamentally new approach: intuitive, interesting and different. The digital world in which we all live today is faster, shorter, more intuitive and brighter than most executives on the client, agency and production side can imagine. How "advertising for young people", for example, is invented and asserted is wild and ridiculous because it has little impact on real young people.

8 Work evaluation

8.1 Introduction

In order to evaluate the proposals made, it was necessary to get feedback from marketing and communication professionals. Their feedback is given in a later part of the paper.

8.2 Experts' evaluation

Daniel Fedorš, marketing research lead, “Memsources”

“The idea to use cross-cultural experience sharing for the better of a company is surely fresh and innovative in terms of modern marketing: it is always beneficial to use foreign ideas and try to adapt them for the local market, in case they work well. I think that Caroline’s idea surely has potential, yet it should further be tested if the use of political topics would be as efficient as it is in Russia. Probably, yes, but I am not sure about the extend. Moreover, the usage of such topics always puts a company into a controversial position, so it is questionable whether the company would be eager to do so. In the case of Regiojet, it might also influence the relationship with the authorities that influence the transport regulation.

I would recommend offering Student Agency to unite the social networks, such as Facebook and Instagram, to communicate a more complex, yet whole brand. And what is true, both Student agency and RegioJet newsletters are boring, the change is needed. I find the offer insightful and full of potential. Yet, the factors I’ve mentioned require further research.”

Kateryna Kovalenko, E-commerce specialist, “Avast”

“CoVID brought a great challenge into the leisure industry and all travelling service providers indeed found themselves in scrutiny. Thus, Caroline’s paper addresses a relevant issue that is not going to be solved overnight. On the other hand, I found it profoundly interesting from the perspective of intercultural exchange of know-how. Despite Russia being a developed country, it often gets overlooked in terms of innovative approaches, the marketing industry not being an exception. An example of Aviasales shows that using a new, friendly tone of voice for the brand can bring incredible benefits. For sure, on the market where users are not that “spoiled” by fresh bold communication strategies and guerilla marketing, the sensitivity of a customer must be quite high which assures that new messages will definitely create traction on the market. That said, there is a good potential in this paper. However, it is crucial to adjust the approach to the Czech market, since there are many specifics like demographics, mentality, purchasing

power etc. In this topic, there is a potential to expand the paper and, maybe, pursue this topic of “communication market fit” in the diploma thesis.”

Jan Kroupa, PR executive, “Insighters”

“Overall, I really like this work - it is innovative and focused on practical implementation, which is always commendable and should be encouraged. However, several organisational issues need to be clarified before the intended implementation. Even though it was stated that Gen Z is the first global generation, the assumption of the communication transfer seems to need further verification. I think more extensive market research is needed to show that elements that work for one market are also applicable to another and can produce similar results. Also, a more critical look at the original company, with a more detailed analysis of the business model, would not hurt. The author has done a massive and creative job, and I think the practical implementation of these ideas could have a great future in the world beyond the walls of an educational institution. This, however, could be the ground for the next paper, that will take all the given suggestions into account.”

Summary of the practical part

The practical part of this work focused on the analysis of the communication marketing strategy of the Russian start-up Aviasails, which proved to be effective, and the application of selected elements of the company's communication style to the Czech company.

Afterwards, three experts in the field evaluated this analysis and the elements proposed for the Czech company and gave recommendations for further development of this topic in the follow-up work.

Conclusion

The aim of the work was to identify the elements of creative communication of the chosen company that could work not only on the home market, but also be transferred to the market of another country - in this case, the Czech Republic. The result of this work had to be positively evaluated by three experts in the field of marketing and communication. The elements were defined and the feedback from the experts was received. Thus, the objectives of the work can be considered achieved.

In the theoretical part, the concept of generations and the peculiarities of marketing aimed at young people - generation Z - was described. It was determined that in order to communicate effectively with young people, the brand needs to be authentic and sincere. Then a definition of marketing communication was given, and it was explained why it is necessary for any company, what is integrated marketing communication and what are the tools and elements of marketing communication. And in this case, in identifying the latest trends in marketing communication, it was determined that the ability to be outward-looking and "direct" with the customer puts the company in a winning position in today's market environment. The final chapter of the theoretical part was a detailed description of the creation of integrated creative communication according to the SOSTAC formula.

Based on the theoretical part, a practical part was also written in which the selected company, its marketing communication and individual tools were analysed and their use ensures success – the assumption about authenticity and sincerity from the theoretical part was verified through a conducted survey. Further, a Czech company was selected in which such elements could be applied and examples of such elements in practice were provided.

All three experts are positive about the proposed elements of the communication strategy and describe them as fresh and innovative. They agree that the work has great potential, but also that further research is needed in several aspects.

On the basis of the feedback it seems that the proposed problem is immensely large for a single work. The experts claim that in order to fully develop the topic in the follow-up papers, aspects such as the Czech target audience's preparedness for controversial humour and mentality, demographics and purchasing power should be considered in more detail. Furthermore, a follow-up paper would be useful in objectively examining the evident impact of CoVID on the leisure industry. Moreover, the following paper would be useful to objectively examine the obvious impact of CoVID on the hospitality industry. After that, specific strategic decisions should no longer be explored with a group of experts, but with a focus group of end users and then prepared for the practical implementation.

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Appendix

The appendix part includes questions that were used to analyse the attitudes of the Russian target audience towards the selected company. When there are no answer options, these are open-ended questions.

The survey questions:

I know what Aviasales does and I can describe it:

- Yes
- No
- I only know the name

My attitude towards Aviasales is...

- Positive
- Rather positive
- Neutral
- Rather negative
- Negative

When planning travel, I use Aviasales...

- Always
- Sometimes
- Never

I owe my knowledge of the brand to...

I associate Aviasales with...

I am...

- Under 17
- 18-26
- 26-40
- 40-60
- 60+

My main occupation is...

- A student
- An employee